

ISWE407P - USER INTERFACE AND USER EXPERIENCE DESIGN LAB

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DATE: 07/07/26

EXPERIMENT – 1

BAD DESIGN 1: ELECTRICAL SWITCH BOARD

Description:

This is an electrical switch board installed on a corridor wall. A charging cable is plugged into the socket and it is taken into the classroom. All sockets of any kind are supposed to be placed inside a room or a staff cabin. Open sockets like these in corridors create unnecessary attention or crowding. In case of any electrical emergency near the electrical panel, it may cause safety hazards.

Source of Photograph: Self Clicked



Place: Silver Jubilee Tower

Reasons why the design is bad:

- Poor electrical design
- Reduces corridor aesthetics
- Potential safety hazard
- Socket is supposed to be placed inside a classroom.
- Cables or forgotten chargers plugged here may get lost.

Suggested Improvement:

- Relocate or remove charging socket
- Cover unused outlets
- Separate charging stations from electrical panels
- Have proper electrical wiring plan

BAD DESIGN 2: FACULTY CABIN CORRIDOR

Description:

This is a section of faculty cabins in SJT, VIT Vellore. Every cabin has identical dimensions, colors, and appearance. Students or faculty must rely on nameplates or cabin numbers

Source of Photograph: Self Clicked



Place: Faculty Rooms – 116 ; Silver Jubilee Tower

Reasons why the design is bad:

- Very small cabins and small room numberplate
- Cabins are identical
- No proper ventilation
- Difficult for first time visitors
- Poor lighting

Suggested Improvement:

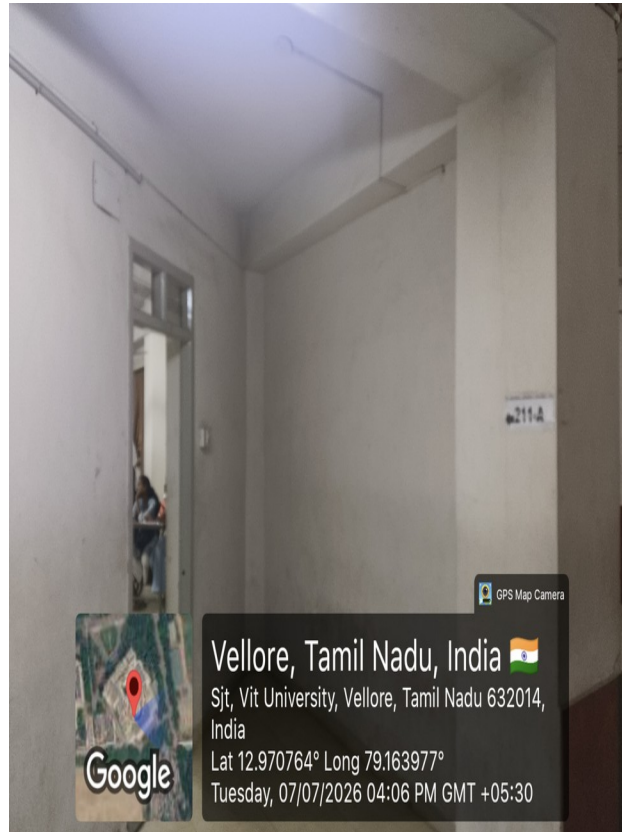
- Introduce color coded sections according to professor designation
- Use larger name/number plates
- Add room map
- Hanging signboards can be used
- Improve corridor lighting

BAD DESIGN 3: CLASSROOM AND ITS ENTRANCE

Description:

This is a classroom in SJT – venue: 211-A. This classroom is placed behind another room and is small making it difficult for students to identify the correct room. The current placement causes confusion especially for new students.

Source of Photograph: Self Clicked



Place: Classroom 211-A ; Silver Jubilee Tower

Reasons why the design is bad:

- Classroom has poor ventilation and network coverage
- Poor visibility from corridor
- No directional guidance
- Classroom very small and suffocating for a strength of 70 students.
- Affects student health

Suggested Improvement:

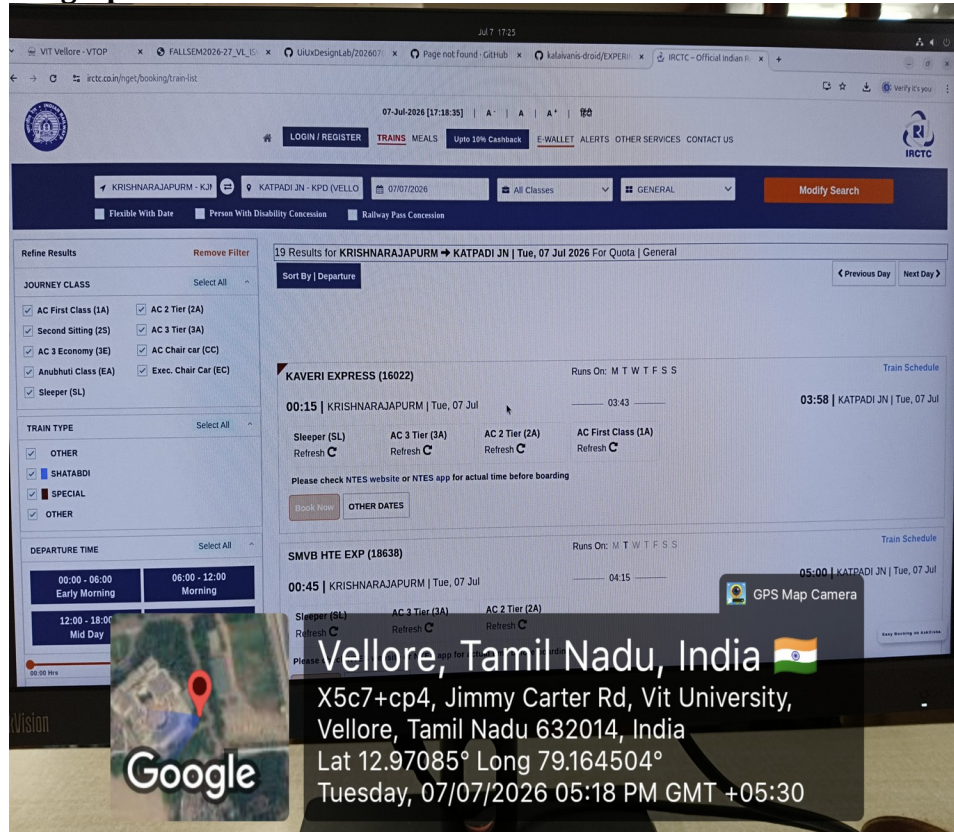
- Increase ventilation
- Improve lighting
- Place WI-FI modems
- Add proper navigation to this classroom
- Potential STORE ROOM for broken furniture

BAD DESIGN 4: IRCTC WEBSITE

Description:

This is the official IRCTC Website used for booking, modifying or cancelling Train reservations. This is a heavily used software especially during peak hours like Tatkal and festival seasons. End users include students, and middle aged to senior citizens.

Source of Photograph: Self Clicked



Place: IRCTC Website : irctc.co.in {picture taken in SJT LAB}

Reasons why the design is bad:

- Too much information is displayed on a single page making the interface heavy.
- Filters on the left consume a lot of place
- Small font size reduces readability
- Similar colours and repetitive layouts make it difficult to distinguish between trains quickly
- Website crashes during tatkal period.
- Poor visible hierarchy

Suggested Improvement:

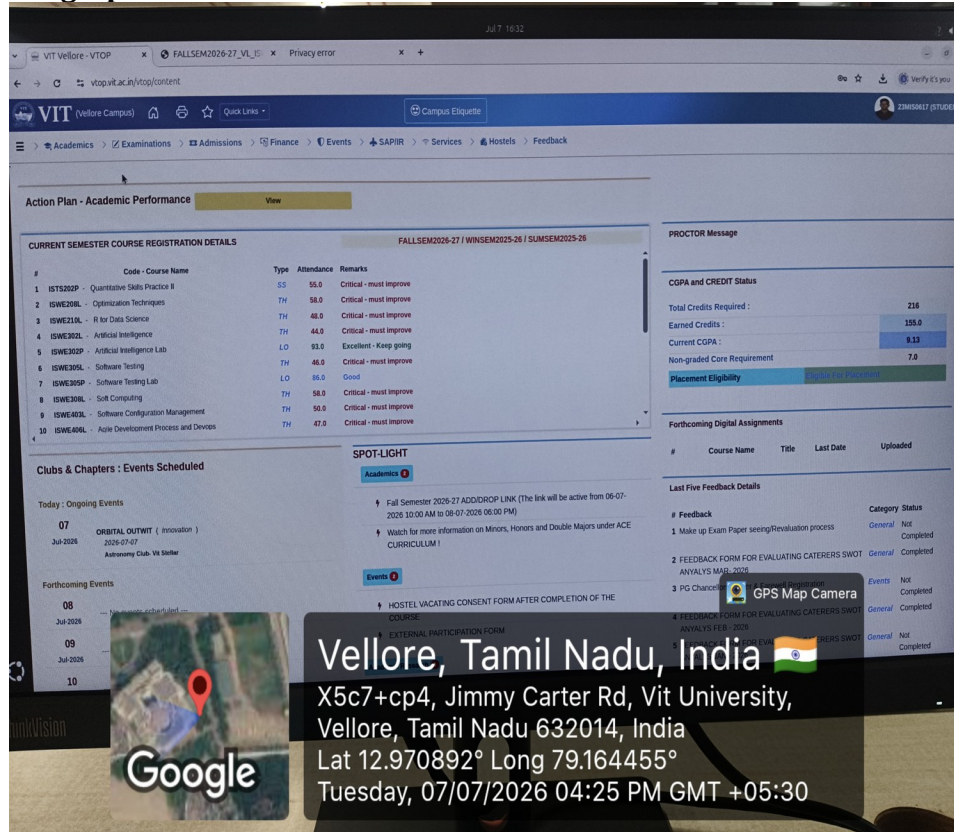
- Use collapsible filters to maximise window display utility
- Increase font size and spacing
- Present each train as a card with clear sections
- Highlight important information such as seat availability.
- Optimize server usage.

BAD DESIGN 5: VTOP WEBSITE

Description:

This is the official VTOP Website used as a University Management Portal for students, faculty, staff, alumni and parents from VIT UNiversity

Source of Photograph: Self Clicked



Place: VTOP Website : vtop.vit.ac.in {picture taken in SJT LAB}

Reasons why the design is bad:

- Too much information is displayed on a single page making the interface heavy.
- Small font size
- Weak visual hierarchy
- Important actions not highlighted
- Highly dense layout

Suggested Improvement:

- Use dashboard cards
- Prioritize frequently used features
- Increase font size
- Improve spacing and grouping
- Allow users to customize dashboard